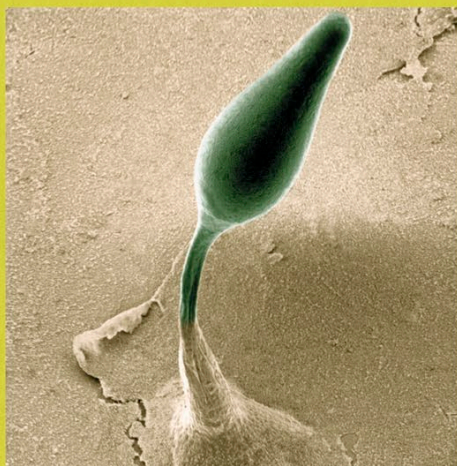


Slime mold Many types of slime mold live as single cells, like amoebas. However, some stick together to form fungus-like bodies that reproduce by releasing spores.



Bacteria Like amoebas, bacteria are single-celled and reproduce by dividing. However, a bacterium's cells are tinier, and its DNA is not packaged inside a nucleus.



Virus Even smaller than bacteria, viruses are little more than capsules containing genetic information, and they can reproduce only inside cells of living things.



Amoeba

The single-celled amoeba is so tiny its entire life cycle can happen in a drop of water. Its one cell never grows bigger than a period on this page. However, like all cells, it is packed with everything it needs to reproduce and make more of its kind.

Each amoeba contains a special spot called a nucleus, which controls what the cell can do.



Greedy amoeba

The amoeba is a microscopic predator. It feeds on smaller single-celled creatures, such as algae. The amoeba swallows its prey by stretching out “fingers” of a clear jelly, called cytoplasm.



The cytoplasm is like a runny jelly that is held inside a thin, oily membrane around the outside of the amoeba.